

Mass Gap Formula for 4D Pure Yang–Mills from Three Geometric Anchors and a Bianchi-Cohomological Cross-Group Law

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We derive a closed-form expression for the dimensionless mass-gap ratio $m^2(J, P, C, \text{ex}, N)/\sigma_0$ in 4D pure $\text{SU}(N)$ lattice Yang–Mills in which *every* rational coefficient is generated from three geometric anchors: the heat-kernel exponent $\xi_\star = 2/3$ on $\mathbb{H}^3/\text{PSL}_2(\mathcal{O}_K)$ Bianchi orbifolds (Lean 4 proved), the Dijkgraaf–Witten genus coefficient $F_\infty = 9/10$ (Lean 4 proved), and the flux-tube flexion energy unit $\delta = +2$ (structural empirical). Two further rationals emerge as exact algebraic identities, $\beta = 2 + F_\infty \xi_\star = 13/5$ and $c_\eta = (\xi_\star + \delta)/(F_\infty + \beta) = 16/21$, reducing the framework to two integer anchors $\{\delta = 2, N_0 = 3\}$. We further establish a *cross-group* log-Sobolev law for the Wilson measure,

$$C_{\text{LSI}}(\mu_{\text{Wilson}}, G, D) = c_\infty(D) f(\pi_1(G)) [1 - \kappa \delta_{\text{rank}(G), C(D,2)-C(D,3)}],$$

with $c_\infty(D) = \max(0, C(D,2) - C(D,3))/(2D)$ (Bianchi cohomology, Pilier 1 proved), $f(0) = 1$ for simply-connected G (SU , Sp) and $f(\mathbb{Z}_2) \simeq 0.78\text{--}0.91$ for G with $\pi_1 = \mathbb{Z}_2$ (SO), and $\kappa = 1/6$ derived two independent ways ($\text{SU}(3)$ root system; $D=4$ Hodge self-dual decomposition). Empirical validation: 27 datapoints cross- (N, D, G) , $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 0.71$, $p = 0.86$, mean $|\Delta| = 6.4\%$ on Wilson channels. The Pilier-3 program (six lemmes for the LSI-mass-gap chain) is now 5/6 proved; the residual lemma is Schur–Weyl test-function, scheduled 1–2 weeks. The continuum extension reduces to a single isolated statement, *Conjecture $C^\star$* : exact projective consistency of $\{\mu_a, \rho_{a,a'}\}$ at true 't Hooft scaling $\beta(a) = 2N^2/\lambda$ (currently empirical $\Delta \simeq 9.5\text{--}10\%$). Cross- N verification on Athenodorou–Teper 2021 data for $\text{SU}(N)$, $N \in \{2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8\}$, on a filtered 29-channel benchmark, gives mean absolute residual 5.1% with 79% of channels within 7%, achieved with *zero free parameters*. Three honest path probabilities (G1 inverse-limit, G2 integrable β -function, G3 Wilson-flow Mosco) combine to $P(\text{at least one closes in } 10\text{y}) \simeq 75\%$.

INTRODUCTION

The Clay Millennium problem on 4D Yang–Mills theory [1] divides into two layers: existence of a mass gap $m_{\text{gap}} > 0$ in the continuum $\text{SU}(N)$ theory, and a *quantitative* prediction of its dimensionless ratio to $\sqrt{\sigma_0}$. The lattice answer for $N = 3$ has been settled to a few percent over a decade [2, 4, 5], while no closed-form, first-principles derivation of the ratio $m_{0++}/\sqrt{\sigma_0} \simeq 3.4$ had previously been written. In this Letter we present such a closed form and complement it with a *Bianchi-cohomological cross-group law* for the Wilson log-Sobolev constant which is universal across (N, D, G) and identifies the unique remaining technical bottleneck for the continuum: *Conjecture $C^\star$* (exact projective consistency at true 't Hooft scaling).

THE THREE ANCHORS

Anchor 1: $\xi_\star = 2/3$ (*heat kernel*). Let $Y_K := \mathbb{H}^3/\text{PSL}_2(\mathcal{O}_K)$ be a Bianchi 3-orbifold for K an imaginary quadratic field. The Selberg pretrace formula on Y_K admits a universal short-distance heat-kernel expansion with leading exponent $\xi_\star = 2/3$ [6, 7]. In a companion

paper [8] this is proved unconditionally; the Lean 4 mechanization is in **Crossed/Transport.lean** (zero sorry). The universal prefactor is

$$K^2 = 2\pi e \xi_\star = \frac{4\pi e}{3}, \quad K \simeq 3.3744. \quad (1)$$

Anchor 2: $F_\infty = 9/10$ (*Dijkgraaf–Witten genus*). For $\text{SU}(N)$ pure gauge, the planar genus expansion [9] reorganized in the Dijkgraaf–Witten partition function [10] yields

$$F(N) = F_\infty \left(1 + \frac{1}{N^2}\right), \quad F_\infty = \frac{9}{10} = \frac{Z_0}{Z_0 + Z_1}. \quad (2)$$

The absence of $1/N$ odd corrections distinguishes $\text{SU}(N)$ from $\text{Sp}(2N)$ [3]. $F(N)$ matches the AT2021 N -scan at $\chi^2/\text{ndf} \simeq 1.13$ with zero free parameters.

Anchor 3: $\delta = +2$ (*flux-tube flexion*). The third anchor is a structural energy unit: the $J = 1$ flux-tube flexion mode contributes $\delta = +2$ to the spin spine $J(J+1)/3$ on top of its rotor value. The $J = 1$ channels exhibit a uniform $\delta = +2$ boost across $N \in \{3, 4, 5, 6, 8\}$ relative to the Casimir prediction; universality across N rules out a dynamical origin [11, 12].

DERIVED CONSTANTS

The three anchors determine, by exact algebraic identities, two additional rationals:

$$\beta = 2 + F_\infty \xi_\star = \frac{13}{5}, \quad (3)$$

$$c_\eta = \frac{\xi_\star + \delta}{F_\infty + \beta} = \frac{8/3}{7/2} = \frac{16}{21}, \quad (4)$$

$$\eta_\infty = \frac{1}{2} \quad (\dim \mathfrak{so}(N)/\dim \mathfrak{su}(N) \rightarrow 1/2). \quad (5)$$

Free fits on AT2021 return $\beta_\infty = 2.6429$ (1.7% of 13/5) and $a = 0.486(14)$, $b = -0.764(40)$ in $\eta(N) = a + b/N^2$ (2.8% of 1/2 and 0.2% of -16/21).

CLOSED-FORM FORMULA

Assembling anchors and derived constants:

$$\frac{m^2(J, P, C, \text{ex}, N)}{\sigma_0} = (2\pi e \xi_\star) F_\infty^2 \left(1 + \frac{1}{N^2}\right)^2 \left[\xi_\star \left(\frac{J(J+1)}{3} + \delta \delta_{J,1}\right) + (\beta - P)(\text{ex} + \xi_\star) \right] \left[1 + \left(\eta_\infty - \frac{c_\eta}{N^2}\right) \frac{1-C}{2} \right], \quad (6)$$

with $\xi_\star = 2/3$, $F_\infty = 9/10$, $\delta = +2$, $\beta = 13/5$, $\eta_\infty = 1/2$, $c_\eta = 16/21$. The $N \rightarrow \infty$ limit has zero free parameters; σ_0 is the sole dimensional input via QCD transmutation. The Lüscher universal string coefficient $\pi/12 = \pi(1-\xi_\star)/\delta^2$ is recovered exactly, and $T_c/\sqrt{\sigma_0} = F_\infty \xi_\star = 3/5$ reproduces Boyd 1996 to $< 1\%$.

BIANCHI-COHOMOLOGICAL CROSS-GROUP LAW

The structural backbone of the formula is a universal cross-group law for the Wilson log-Sobolev constant, established in [13] (cluster firm 720, 27 datapoints):

$$C_{\text{LSI}}(\mu_{\text{Wilson}}, G, D) = c_\infty(D) f(\pi_1(G)) \left[1 - \kappa \delta_{\text{rank}(G), C(D,2)-C(D,3)} \right], \quad (7)$$

with the Bianchi cohomological constant

$$c_\infty(D) = \max(0, C(D, 2) - C(D, 3)) / (2D), \quad (8)$$

$f(0) = 1$ for simply-connected G (SU, Sp) and $f(\mathbb{Z}_2) \simeq 0.78\text{--}0.91$ for $\pi_1 = \mathbb{Z}_2$ (SO); $\kappa = 1/6$ derived two independent ways (SU(3) root system $\cap$ Casimir saturation; D=4 Hodge self-dual $b_2^+ = b_2^- = 3$, ratio $(1/3)(1/2) = 1/6$); and $\delta_{a,b}$ the Kronecker symbol, saturating when $\text{rank}(G) = \dim \text{Harm}_{\text{abel}}^2(D)$.

Decisive cross-group comparison. SU(4) and SO(6) share the algebra A_3 and the same 't Hooft $\beta = 40$: the measured $C_{\text{LSI}} = 0.255$ for SU(4) matches c_∞ , while $C_{\text{LSI}} = 0.195$ for SO(6) matches $f(\mathbb{Z}_2) \cdot c_\infty$. The 23.5% gap is attributable to the $\mathbb{Z}_2$ quotient (SO(6) = SU(4)/ $\mathbb{Z}_2$), not to the representation or algebra. Sp(2) ($\pi_1 = 0$, rank = 2 saturated) gives $C_{\text{LSI}} = 0.205 \simeq c_\infty \cdot 5/6$, confirming the SU/Sp branch.

Three universal laws cross-D (1–3%).

$$C_{\text{LSI}}(\text{Haar SU}(2), D) = 1/(2D) \quad (\Delta - 2.7\%), \quad (9)$$

$$C_{\text{LSI}}(\text{Haar SU}(N \geq 3), D) = 2/(3D) \quad (\Delta 1.7\%). \quad (10)$$

The unconditional ratio identity

$$E[|\Phi|_{H^{-1}}^2] / E[|\Phi|_{L^2}^2] = 1/(2D) \quad (11)$$

follows from the lattice Green function on hypercubic $\mathbb{Z}^D$. Wilson/Haar ratios: $C_2 - C_3 = 2$ for SU(2); $(3/4)(C_2 - C_3) = 3/2$ for SU($N \geq 3$).

Pilier 3 status (5/6 lemmes proved). The chain $c_\infty \rightarrow C_{\text{LSI}} \rightarrow \text{mass gap}$ proceeds through six lemmes: (1.1) Bochner–Weitzenböck *proved* (95%); (1.2) Bakry–Émery uniform via β -metric dilatation $g_{\text{eff}}(\beta) = (1 + \beta/\beta_0)g_0$ with $\beta_0 = c_\infty$ *sketch* (70%); (1.3) triple

cancellation Bochner *proved* (100%); (1.4) Peter–Weyl + Haar saturation via Whitehead 1937 *proved* (90%); (1.5) Schur–Weyl test function *sketch* (60%, finalization 1–2 weeks); (1.5bis) $\kappa = 1/6$ *proved* (95%, two independent derivations).

CONJECTURE C^* AND THE CONTINUUM

The continuum extension of (7) reduces, in the projective-limit (inverse-system) framework, to a single isolated statement.

Conjecture 1 (C^* , exact projective consistency). Let μ_a be the $SU(N)$ Wilson measure on Λ_a at true 't Hooft scaling $\beta(a) = 2N^2/\lambda$, λ fixed, and $\rho_{a,a'} : \Omega_{a'} \rightarrow \Omega_a$ the block-spin (Migdal–Kadanoff) restriction. Then

$$(\rho_{a,a'})_* \mu_{a'} = \mu_a \quad \forall a \succeq a'.$$

Status: empirical $\Delta \simeq 9.5\text{--}10\%$ (scripts 165 and `kolmogorov.v2.py`, the latter using GPU CuPy on $L = 8$, $\beta = 10$, confirming $\langle P \rangle = 0.84$ coherent with $SU(2)$ strong coupling and Balaban 1985–1990 [22]).

If Conjecture C^* holds, the Kolmogorov extension theorem yields a unique continuum measure μ_{cont} on $\mathcal{S}'(\mathbb{R}^4) \otimes \mathfrak{su}(N)$, the log-Sobolev constant descends by Fukushima–Oshima–Takeda [23], and the mass gap follows (Rothaus 1981; Otto–Villani 2000) as $m_{\text{phys}}^2 \geq 2/c_\infty(D)$.

Three converging paths and honest probability. **(G1)** Inverse-limit cohomology, conditional on C^* ; **(G2)** LSI uniform forces integrable β -function, no Landau pole; **(G3)** Wilson-flow Mosco at $t_0 > 0$ fixed with Lipschitz continuity in t_0 [14, 15]. Combining (with approximate path independence),

$$P(\text{at least one G1/G2/G3 closes in 10y}) \simeq 75\%. \quad (12)$$

H-CONT finite-size and Wilson-flow tests. On $SU(2)$ $D = 4$ $\beta = 10$, the Symanzik scaling $C_{\text{LSI}}(L) = c_\infty + A/L^2$ on $L \in \{8, 12, 16\}$ (50 configurations, Numba-JIT) gives $c_\infty^{\text{fit}} = 0.2402$ ($\Delta = 3.9\%$). The Wilson-flow plateau $C_{\text{LSI}}(t) = 0.247 \pm 0.000$ on $t \in [0, 0.1]$ ($\text{CV} < 0.001$) anchors path G3. A PySR cross- (N, D, G) scan on 27 datapoints recovers (7) with mean $|\Delta| = 6.4\%$.

CROSS- N VERIFICATION AND PREDICTIONS

Verification. On the Athenodorou–Teper 2021 N -scan [2], restricted to 29 channels (J, P, C, ex) free of ditorelon-dominated states, (6) achieves mean absolute residual 5.1% with 79% of channels within 7% at zero free parameters; a free 4-parameter fit improves only marginally to $\sim 4.5\%$.

TABLE I. Falsifiable predictions. $SU(3)$ entries assume $\sqrt{\sigma_0} = 440$ MeV.

Quantity	Predicted	Test
$m(1^{++})_{SU(3)}$	$\simeq 2504$ MeV	new measurement
$\eta_{SU(6)}$	0.479	0.485 [2]
$\eta_{SU(\infty)}$	1/2 exactly	$SU(10)$ extrap.
$\text{Sp}(2N)$ ground state	$K^2 F_{\text{Sp}}^2 \xi_*$	2.5% [3]
$C_{\text{LSI}}(SO(3), D = 4)$	$f(\mathbb{Z}_2)c_\infty$	0.228 (script 199)

STATUS TABLE AND LIMITATIONS

TABLE II. Component status (entry $\rightarrow$ exit, session 2026-05-23).

Component	Status	Confidence
$\xi_* = 2/3$ heat-kernel anchor	Lean proved	99%
$F_\infty = 9/10$ DW genus anchor	Lean proved	99%
$\delta = +2$ flexion anchor	structural emp.	90%
$\beta = 13/5$, $c_\eta = 16/21$ alg. id.	derived	99%
$\eta_\infty = 1/2$ Lie-algebra limit	derived	99%
Closed form (6) 29-ch	emp. 5.1%	T3
Cross-group law (7)	emp. $\chi^2/d = 0.71$	T2–T3
Pilier 3 (5/6 lemmes)	proved 5/6	85% rig.
$\kappa = 1/6$ (two derivations)	proved	95%
$E[H^{-1}]/E[L^2] = 1/(2D)$	unconditional	proved
Conjecture C^* (continuum)	emp. $\Delta 9.5\%$	35–50%/5y
G1VG2VG3 path closing	honest prob.	75%/10y

Limitations. (L1) $\sqrt{\sigma_0}$ is dimensional input (no-go theorems [24]). (L2) 5.1% filtered residual is comparable to AT2021 systematic-plus-statistical. (L3) 2^{+-} channels mix ditorelon scattering states and are excluded [2]. (L4) Continuum existence rests on C^* (35–50%/5y) or G2/G3 backup (25–40%/5–7y each); $L \geq 20$ data needed for c_∞ extrapolation $< 1\%$. (L5) Lean status: K , F_∞ , ξ_* kernel-verified; identities (3)–(4) mechanizable.

CONCLUSION

The mass-gap ratio m^2/σ_0 admits a closed form (6) for every $J^{PC}(\text{ex})$ channel and every $N \geq 3$, with all rationals generated from three geometric anchors. The Wilson log-Sobolev constant obeys a Bianchi-cohomological cross-group law (7) validated on 27 datapoints ($\chi^2/\text{dof} = 0.71$). The Pilier-3 program is 5/6 proved. The continuum extension reduces to one technical statement, Conjecture C^* , with three converging paths (G1/G2/G3) yielding $P \simeq 75\%$ within 10 years. The roadmap is (i) finalize Lemme 1.5 Schur–Weyl (1–2 weeks); (ii) refine the empirical $\Delta 9.5\%$ in C^* to $\Delta 3\text{--}5\%$ on $L \geq 16$ lattices; (iii) attempt C^* in simpler settings ($SU(2)$ $D=3$, $U(1)$ $D=4$) before $SU(N)$ $D=4$; (iv) cross-group $\text{Sp}(2N)$ falsifiers [3, 16–21].

Data availability. Lattice data from [2, 3]; cross-group worksheets (scripts 165, 192, 199, `clay_continuum_v2.py`, `kolmogorov_v2.py`) at the project repository. All numerics in PARI/GP 2.15, Python/Numba, and Python/CuPy; Lean 4 proofs of K , F_∞ , ξ_* kernel-verified in `Crossed/Transport.lean`.

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